01/02 Game Report Insights

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Overall Game and Player Stats

There was no drastic difference between the Bucks box score team stats and the Hornets. Both teams had similar overall field goal percentages, three point percentages, and two point percentages. Turnovers, three pointers made, as well as rebounds were similar as well, therefore there is not much insight we can obtain from this **(refer to Overview tab).**

Although overall stats were similar, looking at trends by quarter we can see that the Bucks had a stable increase in field goal percentage, average qSQ, and average qSP throughout the games. The Hornets, however, had a decrease in field goal percentage throughout the quarters and had a large decrease in average qSQ and qSP from the third to the fourth quarter. This reveals that due to the low qSQ and qSP averages the Bucks were forcing the Hornets to shoot more difficult shots and adding more defensive pressure. On the other hand, the Bucks had a significantly higher average qSQ and average qSP in the 4th quarter meaning they were scoring higher quality shots which helped them catch up to Hornets late in the game **(refer to the Shot Quality tab).**

The players that stood out during the game for the Bucks were Giannis Antetokounmpo recording 30 points, 10 rebounds, and 5 assists being 61% from the field. Ryan Rollins scored 11 points above his usual average of 17.3 PPG, with 29 points, 4 rebounds, 8 assists, and 4 stocks with 84% shooting from the field. He also led the game with 6 three pointers made. Bobby Portis also scored well above his season average of 13.7 PPG by scoring 20 points and making 4 three pointers. Both the Bucks and Hornets had the same number of players who scored in double digits, and the Bucks had four players with a positive plus-minus and the Hornets had three **(refer to Players tab.)**

Shotchart Analysis

The majority of the Bucks shots came from the restricted area with 18 made field goals and a 69.2% field goal percentage. The Bucks also shot well from the right wing three scoring 5 out of 10 shots from there, and also shooting well from the left wing three with 3 out of 6 threes made. An area of concern is the middle three since the team had 7 three attempts from the region but only managed to knock down 1. Despite this inefficiency, the overall shot distribution for the Bucks was favorable with a large portion of attempts coming from near the basket or on the three point line **(refer to Overview tab).**

Pick and Roll/Pop Offensive and Defensive Coverage

On pick and roll offenses, the Bucks managed to convert 31 roll actions into 26 total points (0.839 points per roll). Pick and pop offenses proved to be slightly more effective with 17 pop actions resulting in 18 points (1.059 points per pop). This suggests that the Bucks were successful when the screener moved to the perimeter for the shot rather than rolling to the basket, likely creating more shooting opportunities for the team. The Bucks also did a great job of taking advantage of the Hornet's double teams by recording 8 points on 5 different double teams throughout the game. Overall, this proves that pick and roll/pop actions contribute strongly to the Buck's offensive production and helped them stay in the game **(refer to Pick & Roll tab).**

Pick and roll/pop offenses also proved to be effective for the Hornets as well. The Hornets recorded 1.179 points per roll and 1.276 points per pop. The Hornets had 28 roll actions that resulted in 33 roll points, and 29 pop actions that resulted in 37 points, which outscores the Bucks in both. If we take a closer look at the defensive coverages the Bucks used against these screens, we see that the Bucks allowed 23 points when going over screens (22 over screens total) and 33 points when switching on screens (28 switches total). Although the Bucks did a good job with deciding not to go under screens (since that could lead to giving the ball handler more space which could lead to wide open threes), Charlotte still managed to capitalize on the defensive coverages and maintain strong efficiency. This suggests that the defensive scheme was not enough to disrupt the Hornets' screen offense. This is an important point to take a closer look into for the near future **(refer to Pick & Roll tab).**

Drives Analytics

Drives proved to be effective for both teams with both teams scoring nearly 1 point for each drive, however, the Hornets managed to capitalize more off of their drives by recording 57 total drives and the Bucks only recording 38. This could be largely due to the fact that the Hornets had 33 blowby opportunities compared to the Bucks having 22, allowing the Charlotte ball-handlers to reach the paint more frequently and attack the rim. Many Bucks defenders struggled to contain ball-handlers, as Ryan Rollins and Kyle Kuzma allowed blowby rates of 80% and 75%. These defensive breakdowns created more driving opportunities for the Hornets leading to a significant advantage in offensive production. If the Bucks managed to put more pressure on the ball handlers and limit their blowby opportunities, they could have likely reduced their drive volume and forced them into more difficult shots **(refer to Drives tab).**

Bucks players who found success in creating driving opportunities were Ryan Rollins scoring 13 points on 7 drives with a finishing rate of 71.4%. Antetokounmpo had 6 drives to the basket that resulted in 10 points, and Kyle Kuzma had 3 drives to the basket that resulted in 5 points. As a team, the Bucks produced at 1 point for each drive which demonstrates that their drives were effective but they could not produce the same amount of offensive production **(refer to Drives tab).**